Chapter Eight

Journeys Without Maps

> ‘We must make it our business not to pass this way again.’[1]
>
> (McGeorge Bundy)

> ‘It is safer to start with the assumption that history, whatever its value in educating the judgement, teaches no “lessons” … The past is infinitely various, an inexhaustible storehouse of events from which we can prove anything or its contrary.’[2]
>
> (Sir Michael Howard)

> ‘Gentlemen, I’m not a sentimentalist by nature, but I wonder now if I don’t know what’s in every heart in this room. I want to suggest that we get down on our knees and say a short prayer of thanks for our deliverance.’[3]
>
> (General Buck Turgidson)

When did the Cuban missile crisis end? If the crisis lasted thirteen days, then one answer is shortly after 9.00am (Washington Time) on 28 October, when Kennedy learned of Khrushchev’s announcement that:

> the Soviet government, in addition to previously issued instructions on the cessation of further work on the building sites for the weapons, has issued a new order on the dismantling of the